Knowledge organiser (SUMMIT) — Creative practice, studio roles and pathways

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 2 Part 2 · Big question: How do interdisciplinary creative groups take a structural commission from studio prototype to public installation?

Core studio focus

Family: Studio suite

Big question: How do interdisciplinary creative groups take a structural commission from studio prototype to public installation?

• Examine the professional ecosystem connecting lead artists, structural engineers, specialist fabricators, and curators.

• Analyse how material specifications, structural load, and surface finishes are tested in studio workshops.

• Produce a Studio practice & Pathways board combining role analysis with a technical joint/surface prototype.

Essential vocabulary

• interdisciplinary: Different specialists (artists, engineers, fabricators, curators) working together on one project.

• prototype: A working test section built at real or scaled size to prove a joint or surface finish works.

• specification: A precise technical instruction naming materials, dimensions, and surface treatments.

• structural load: How weight and force travel through beams, arches, and joints so a piece stands safely.

• curatorial narrative: The story and layout a curator designs to help the public engage with an exhibition.

Three-step studio method

Step 1: Map the commission workflow across roles: I annotate the studio workflow diagram showing how my Week 1 brief moves from Designer to Engineer, Fabricator, and Curator.

Step 2: Build a physical joint & patina prototype: I construct a 8 cm structural corner joint using laminated card, a slotted gusset plate, embossed foil rivets, and dark iron wash.

Step 3: Write the technical specification note: Beside my mounted prototype, I write the exact fabrication spec (layer thicknesses, bond method, and 3-value patina sequence).